

Ronnie Taylor

Senior Software Engineer • Full-Stack • Client-Facing Technical Leadership

Pismo Beach, CA | 803-448-2567 | hello@ronnietaylor.com

SUMMARY

I am a full-stack software engineer with deep experience building and maintaining production software across front end, back end services, payment platforms, cloud infrastructure, and developer tooling. Throughout my career, I have worked directly with clients and stakeholders to translate their needs into reality. Comfortable leading teams, managing technical relationships, or working as an individual contributor. Currently deepening hands-on Python, React, and AI tooling skills.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Ruby, JavaScript / TypeScript, SQL, PHP

Frameworks & Libraries: React, Ruby on Rails, Ractive, Sinatra, FastAPI, Flask, Node.js

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, ECS, S3, RDS, ElastiCache, CloudWatch), Azure (Blob Storage, backup infrastructure), Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Vault, Consul

FinOps & Cloud Cost: AWS infrastructure optimization, reliability engineering, downtime cost reduction, build pipeline efficiency

AI Tooling: Private AI infrastructure (Open WebUI), RAG pipelines over internal documents, AI coding tools (GitHub Copilot, Opencode, Hermes)

Customer & Stakeholder: Client discovery & needs analysis, proposal writing, sales engineering, executive-level communication, technical escalation support

DevOps & Tooling: CI/CD (GitHub Actions, CircleCI), Git, Datadog, ScoutAPM, Microsoft SQL Server

Practices: Test-driven development, OAuth2, payment systems, security auditing and remediation, mentorship

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Sabbatical — AI Tooling & Open Source

July 2025 – Present

After leaving my previous role, took a deliberate break to focus on learning and building — specifically around running AI models on private infrastructure, an area that matters for organizations that handle sensitive data.

- Deployed and ran Open WebUI — a self-hosted, ChatGPT-like interface — using Docker as a private alternative to cloud-based AI services.
- Built Python-based tool servers that let a locally-running AI model call external services and APIs, keeping the AI and its data entirely on private infrastructure.
- Set up and tuned RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) pipelines — systems that let an AI model search and reason over an organization's internal documents rather than relying on training data alone. Particularly useful for organizations that cannot or prefer not to send private data to third-party AI services.
- Studied open-source projects (Opencode, Hermes, and others) that use AI to plan and carry out multi-step programming tasks, deepening practical Python fluency.
- Extended existing Python scripting work: hardware interfacing on Raspberry Pi (sensors, LCD displays) and enterprise utility scripts for downloading and decrypting infrastructure backups.

Senior Staff Engineer — Platform Team Tech Lead • Veracross • Remote

March 2024 – June 2025

- Led the migration of the CI/CD pipeline from CircleCI to GitHub Actions, cutting build times by 45%.
- Served as the technical escalation point for complex customer-facing issues, working directly with clients to diagnose difficult problems and drive resolution — a role that required translating technical findings into clear guidance for non-technical stakeholders.

- Worked with external security vendors to audit the application for vulnerabilities, then led the remediation effort across the engineering team.
- Introduced AI coding tools — GitHub Copilot and locally-hosted language models — that measurably sped up development and reduced repetitive work.
- Led platform engineering for a globally distributed team spanning Australia, South America, the United States, and Europe.
- Organized company-wide technical talks to spread knowledge across teams and mentored engineers across time zones.

Staff Product Engineer • Veracross • Remote

March 2020 – March 2024

- Extended the authentication system to support multiple third-party login providers via OAuth2.
- Built a fine-grained permission system for controlling employee access to internal tools, cutting onboarding and offboarding time by 50%.
- Added multi-language support to core applications so the company could serve international customers without maintaining separate codebases.
- Worked with the DevOps team to modernize AWS infrastructure, improving reliability and reducing downtime costs.
- Standardized Docker images for SQL Server databases so developers could spin up a working local environment in minutes instead of hours.
- Managed server backup infrastructure on Azure, gaining hands-on familiarity with their storage ecosystem and interfaces.

Web Services Manager • Veracross • Remote

March 2018 – January 2020

- Led a team responsible for APIs, payment processing, and internal services — maintaining 99.99% uptime throughout.
- Introduced test-driven development across the team, raising automated test coverage from near zero to roughly 85% and dramatically reducing bugs reaching production.
- Built the organization's first CI/CD pipeline on CircleCI, cutting deployment time by 70%.

Senior Software Engineer • Veracross • Remote

April 2016 – March 2018

- Helped extend and maintain a tuition and fees payment platform that processes over \$1 billion annually, improving system availability to 99.998%.
- Set up monitoring and alerting with the DevOps team that reduced downtime incidents by 40%.
- Tightened security controls across the payment system to protect customer data and meet compliance requirements.

Lead Software Developer • AppZero • Remote, US & Canada

May 2012 – March 2016

Led development of the web service powering AppZero's tool for moving Windows applications between data centers — built in Ruby, Sinatra, Rails, PostgreSQL, and AWS.

- Served as a sales engineer alongside executive leadership, joining customer conversations to explain the platform's technical capabilities, address objections, and demonstrate how the product solved specific migration challenges.
- Worked directly with leadership, sales, and product to turn business goals into technical requirements and translate complex infrastructure concepts for non-technical buyers.
- Designed the core architecture of the Zapp platform with scalability, reliability, and security as primary constraints.
- Delivered a migration tool that sped up customer onboarding, reduced downtime during migrations, and consistently received strong customer feedback.

Independent Web Developer & Consultant • Ronnie Taylor Consulting • Remote, US & Canada

January 2007 – May 2012

Ran a web development consultancy serving clients across the US and Canada. Responsible for the full client lifecycle: prospecting and business development, discovery and needs analysis, proposal writing, solution design, delivery, and ongoing support.

- Interfaced with clients daily in both a sales and delivery capacity — listening to business needs, translating them into technical proposals, and collaborating with designers and other developers to build and ship solutions.
- Built an e-commerce platform for a retail client that grew their online sales by 20% in the first quarter after launch.
- Implemented SEO improvements and CMS solutions (Drupal, WordPress, CodeIgniter) that gave clients control over their own content and improved search visibility.

Interactive Media Manager • The Herald (McClatchy Newspapers) • Rock Hill, SC *April 2007 – April 2008*

- Managed IT and Interactive Media departments, covering project management, product development, web programming, annual budgeting, and coordination between local and corporate offices.

Technology Sales Representative • Internet Service Provider • US *2004 – 2006*

- Sold a specialized network-level web content filtering appliance to K–12 school districts, targeting technology directors with cold outreach and consultative selling.
- Developed fluency in translating technical product capabilities — network-level traffic inspection, filtering policies, compliance — into business outcomes for non-technical buyers.

EDUCATION

Winthrop University

Business Administration and Management

Vocal Performance